CPS School Council Minutes (Sept. 12th 2024)

Approval of Agenda
-Gena & Erin

Approval of Minutes (May)
-Rebecca & Katie

Principal Report
-Ms. MacNeil give a report on the start of the school year.
-Great start to the school year
-Starting leadership activities (lunch helper training for grade 5,6,7)
-Bus patrollers also being trained (16 grade 6,7,8 students). Also have students helping kindergarteners to get on the buses.
-New soccer nets on back field
-Terry Fox run on Sept. 26th – Grade 8th organizing movement activities
-Conestogo Colt groups (kids are assigned to groups during whole time they are at school).
-Working on building school vision and core values. Includes feedback from kids on what is important to them. Gives common language to whole school, updated each year.
-Calendar feature on website is now being used. Families can check that for activities with the entire school (pizza day, Terry Fox Run, etc.)
-Lunch Lady starts Sept. 25th (every Wed. food to order online, includes Halal, Vegan, Vegetarian, Gluten Free options)
-Pizza – will be once per month again (that is available to order on School Day).
-Drill week end of Sept (fire, tornado).
-Messages to Volunteers with Vulnerable Sector checks that need to have them updated.
-In need of Strong Start volunteers to help with reading program
- Renovations included updates to grade 8 room (ac, heating and shelving) and updates to the basement area

-Feedback should be given to the board because the construction company used created unsafe waste on sidewalk that the community uses (nails, broken glass).

Questions:
-How many students: 204 (compared to 215 from last year)

Teacher's Report – Mrs. Cochrane
-Cross Country is starting next week with practices during second break. The meet will be on Oct. 1st.
-Gym clothes are now available on school-day. These are not mandatory, but a nice to have for gym classes and school sports. For gym class students do need proper shoes (no crocs or sandals). Rubber soled running shoes are recommended.

Field Trips Coming Up for Grades 7 and 8s:
-Oct 9th – Coding workshop through ESQ at UW. Called Intertwined Tales which includes literacy and coding
-Oct 16th – Peter Pan performance in Stratford. Includes workshops at the school before and after performance with kids. They come from Stratford to the school. This will be part of the drama program. Thanks to Ms. Thiel who did a professional development program during the summer and then received these benefits before and after the performance at no charge.
-Oct. 25th – Outdoor education field trip to Laurel Creek to do pond study (Grade 7)
-Oct 29th – 2 free let's talk science programs. Crime lab – Grade 7. Cells – Grade 8
-Jan. 10th –Crawford Lake for Indigenous studies program
-Other trips being investigated: Skiing in February, Hockey Game

-Sept. 27th – Region of Waterloo is planting micro forest in the back-field area of the school that is not used. Grade 7 and 8s will be taking classes out one at a time to help with planting.
-Climate Action grant was received last year. Using it for a story walk garden (posts and plaques that contain pages of a book as they look at the garden). Mrs. Cochrane installed the posts over the summer (thank you!) and Ms. Kellough will add the pages of the book. Thank you to Home Hardware in St. Jacobs who gave us a discount so that all the supplies could be included in the $500 grant. Planning to have it ready for Fun Fair.
-Would like to display Sustainable Village from last year's Grade 7 class at the Fun Fair. Will add to it with this year's Grade 7 class.

Council Elections
-Rebecca explained the different roles on CPS School Council
-Ballots were passed around and filled out for each position:

Co-Chairs: Katie & Rebecca
Community Rep: Kim
WRAPSC Rep: Rotation of Members
Secretary: Kristin
Treasurer: Gena
Parent Members: Jen, Megan, Vanessa, Mark, Alisha, Julianna, Jeremy (in absentia),Erin

-Erin moved that we accept all nominations for the 2024/25 CPS School Council. Mark seconded. Motion passed.

Budget
-Gena presented the proposed budget for the upcoming year.

Revenue
-Discussion around expected revenue at the Fun Fair, including silent auction and what the difference will be with new band system for games.
-Mabel's Labels – Does it bring in $100? Last year only brought in $60. Could we also run a fundraiser with a different brand? Both give back 20%. Kim will decide what brand we should go with.

-Will be getting an HST rebate.
-Flip Give – Have an account, but aren't pushing this. Looking for a new person to monitor the page. Should send out a school-day email (later, after Fun Fair is done).
-Craft show is fully booked with vendors, so that revenue is confirmed.
-Katie investigating a different vendor for Spirit Wear
-Discussion about doing a Poinsettia / Holiday Fundraiser. We have done this in the past, but it was a lot of work and logistics. Time better spent getting more parents to come to Bingo.

Expenses
-Rebecca went through the proposed expenses in the budget.
-Suggested looking into grants that could cover some costs of the guest speakers
-If passed, the proposed budget will result in a $4.6k surplus that would be carried over to the next year school (used as funds for the next fun fair).

-Remove the Recess Items for now and see if we can add it back in after the Fun Fair depending on how the fundraiser goes.

Motion to pass the budget moved by Gena. Seconded by Katie. Motion Passed.

WRAPSC
– Will discuss next meeting

Vulnerable Sector Checks
– Reminder that people need those to volunteer

Fun Fair
-Have items confirmed for Silent Auction, but have not collected that many physical items. These typically come in closer to the event.
-Order forms for fun fair are due today for food orders. Bracelets and tickets can also be purchased at the fun fair.
-Katie arranged for a few more volunteers and let us know where we still needed help.
-We will have a CPS School Council table again this year
-Many of last year's grade 8's will come back to help.
-Discussed how to announce Raffle Prizes at the end of the night. Will look to use a wired or a wireless microphone.

Adjournment
Mark motioned to adjourn meeting and Rebecca seconded. Motion Passed.